

The private toast

CASE: MERIDIAN / 30 OCT 2026 / F1



Certified findings

Grant Larceny has died from a botanical cardiac toxin applied inside his private silver coupe and along its rim. The cordial decanter and buffet food are clean. Service staff have been cleared. One guest acted alone.

Grant's unfinished business

CASE: MERIDIAN / 30 OCT 2026 / F2

NAMING AGREEMENT

Veto power, museum renaming and management changes.

OBJECTS & PAYMENTS

Disputed title, altered records and unpaid design invoices.

PERSONAL PAPERS

Family trust amendments and threats to professional reputations.

Certified findings

Grant's papers concern the naming agreement, disputed objects, unpaid invoices, a rewritten family trust and threats to careers. His handwriting appears beside several guests' names. Before considering access to the drink, ask what each guest stood to lose.

The salon door register

CASE: MERIDIAN / 30 OCT 2026 / F3

- 6:40** Cordial poured; inside and rim of coupe checked clean.
- 6:40–6:49** Coupe remains in Donor Salon. All guest entries logged by steward.
- 6:49** Grant drinks from his private coupe.

Certified findings

The coupe and its rim were checked clean when the cordial was poured at 6:40; Grant drank at 6:49. The glass remained inside the Donor Salon. A door steward logged every guest entry and checked faces against badge photographs. No other entrance was open. The steward could see the door, not the service table. A visit before 6:40 is outside the poisoning window. The cabinet key book is also being checked.

The missing conservation sample

CASE: MERIDIAN / 30 OCT 2026 / F4

- 6:00** Reference sample verified inside locked cabinet.
- SETUP** Single key issued and returned against the key book.
- 6:35** Reference sample missing; cabinet relocked.

Certified findings

The toxin sample was in a locked cabinet at 6:00 and missing at 6:35. There was one key, loaned to guests during setup and logged by the materials desk. The cabinet was relocked after each loan; there were no unlogged openings or duplicate keys. No key or sample was passed between guests. Several perfectly ordinary errands involved borrowing that key.

A thread in the poison

CASE: MERIDIAN / 30 OCT 2026 / F5



Certified findings

Concentrated toxin inside the coupe and on its rim follows linen wipe tracks. A gold thread is trapped in that poisoned smear: a toxin-dampened cloth applied the poison, rather than merely cleaning up afterward. The thread matches the museum's white linen with gold seams. Guests received that linen or blue paper wipes; blue paper cannot leave this thread. The 6:39 inventory records what each guest carried. Spare linen stayed sealed; no cloth was exchanged. Linen possession alone does not identify the poisoner.
